Christian indigenous societies of the New World, were lesser and unevolved, who needed to be ‘civilised’ and ‘reformed’ through the instrumentality of international law.

Scholars believe that the ‘liberal’ globalised civilisation is, in fact, merely a secularised version of the Westphalian civilisation whose secularisation is largely attributed to the nature of the Enlightenment itself. Therefore, it is important to examine the Christian secular nature of the Enlightenment and its coloniality. On this subject, the work of Dr. S.N. Balagangadhara and Dr. De Roover is incisive and critical.[27]

Christianity, Enlightenment and Coloniality

It is often assumed that the Enlightenment represented the predominance of reason over faith not just for Europe but also for the rest of the world. That non-European civilisations had their own respective journeys and subjectivities is often lost in this simultaneously deliberate and unconscious Europeanisation of world history. Colonised indigenous societies have suffered the most as a consequence of this approach since their journeys of millennia, their lived experiences, their onto-epistemological systems, their individual and collective identities and their right to agency all have been casually and superciliously dismissed as legends, myths and superstitions. That this ‘Enlightened’ attitude continues till date through the colonialised native establishment makes it imperative for us to understand the so-called secular character of the Enlightenment. While it is relatively easy to discern the direct nexus between the Protestant Reformation and the Peace of Westphalia, which demonstrates the latter’s Christian character, the Enlightenment could be mistaken for a break from religion, more specifically from Christianity, towards a more ‘liberal’ and ‘secular’ outlook owing to the claim that it marked the beginning of ‘*the* Age of Reason’. Therefore, this claim needs to be examined in order to understand whether the Enlightenment and the values that stemmed from it were secular, as in truly irreligious, or ‘Christian secular’. Its impact on the politico-theological framework of the European coloniser needs to be examined as well.

While discussing the Enlightenment, De Roover starts with a dissection of the idea of religious toleration, which is often treated as a value that arose out of the Enlightenment. This makes the value as well as the